FLORIDA COURTS
E-FILING AUTHORITY

MEETING MINUTES

Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors
June 22, 2026
8:30 a.m., ET

The Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors held their annual meeting on June 22, 2026. The meeting was held at the Omni Championsgate, Orlando, Florida, in conjunction with the Florida Court Clerks and Comptrollers' annual conference.

☐ **The Hon. Tara S. Green., CGCIO, CPM, Chair** (Clerk of Court, Hernando County)
☑ **The Hon. Todd Newton, Vice Chair | District III** (Clerk of Court, Gilchrist County)
☑ **The Hon. Kevin Madok, CPA | District VII** (Clerk of Court, Monroe County)
☑ **The Hon. John Tomasino** (Clerk of the Court, Florida Supreme Court)
☑ **The Hon. Brad E. Embry | District I** (Clerk of Court, Okaloosa County)
☑ **The Hon. Steve Land | District II** (Clerk of Court, Lafayette County)
☑**The Hon. Laura E. Roth, Esq. | District IV** (Clerk of Court, Volusia County)
☑**The Hon. Rachel Sadoff | District V** (Clerk of Court, Brevard County)
☑ **The Hon. Karen E. Rushing| District VI** (Clerk of Court, Sarasota County)

☑ Present ☐ Not Present

I. Introduction and Roll Call

As the Honorable Tara S. Green, Chair, was excused as unable to attend, the Honorable Todd Newton, Vice Chair, presided. The Honorable Todd Newton opened the meeting at 8:32 a.m., ET, welcoming everyone to the annual meeting of the Florida Courts E-Filing Authority Board of Directors. He asked Beth Allman to call the roll. A quorum was present.

II. Public Comment-Agenda Items Only

There was no one wishing to speak.

The Honorable **TARA S. GREEN** Chair Clerk, Clay County
The Honorable **TODD NEWTON** Vice Chairman Clerk, Gilchrist County District III
The Honorable **LAURA E. ROTH, ESQ.** Secretary/Treasurer Clerk, Volusia County District IV
The Honorable **JOHN TOMASINO** Clerk of the Court Florida Supreme Court
The Honorable **BRAD E. EMBRY** Clerk, Okaloosa County District I
The Honorable **STEVE LAND** Clerk, Lafayette County District II
The Honorable **JUAN FERNANDEZ-BARQUIN, ESQ.** Clerk, Miami-Dade County District VII
The Honorable **RACHEL SADOFF** Clerk, Brevard County District V
The Honorable **KAREN E. RUSHING** Clerk, Sarasota County District VI

III. Adoption of the Agenda

The Honorable Kevin Madok made a motion to adopt the agenda. The Honorable Laura E. Roth, Esq., seconded the motion and all voted in favor.

IV. Annual Authority Meeting

The Honorable Todd Newton opened the Annual Authority meeting and made brief annual report then moved into he elections for Vice Chairman and Secretary/Treasurer. (see Attachment 1)

V. Election of the Vice Chair and Secretary/treasurer

The Honorable Kevin Madok, Secretary/Treasurer, took the chair as The Honorable Todd Newton expressed interest in continuing the position of Vice Chair for the next program year.

The Honorable Kevin Madok asked if there were any other nominations from the floor for Vice Chair. Hearing none, The Honorable Todd Newton was named Vice Chair.

The Chairmanship was handed back to Clerk Newton and the meeting continued.

The Honorable Todd Newton took a moment of personal privilege to thank the Honorable Kevin Madok for his six years of service on the Board, most of those years serving as Secretary/Treasurer. He presented Clerk Madok with a commemorative plaque.

The Honorable Todd Newton asked for nominations for Secretary/Treasurer. The Honroable John Tomasino nominated Laura E. Roth, Esq., for the position. As there wer no other nominationsfor the position, The Honorable Laura E. Roth was named Secretary/Treasurer.

In recognition of the newest member who will join the Board on July 1, The Honorable Todd Newton welcomed The Honorable Juan Fernandez-Barquin, who was attending remotely.

The Honorable Todd Newton closed the Annual meeting of the Authority and opened the Annual meeting of the Board of Directors.

VI. Reading and Approval of the Minutes

The Honorable Kevin Madok reviewed the May 5, 2026, minutes. As there were no edits or corrections to the minutes, the minutes were accepted as presented.

VII. Treasurer's Report

Monthly Financial Report

The Honorable Kevin Madok presented the April 2026 financial report.

- At the end of April 2026, assets were at $5.16 M
- Liabilities were $2.2 M
- Net income for April was $1.17M with expense of $1.17 M.
- Net income year to date was $524,000, $435,000 better than the budgeted net income. The outperformance of the budget has been driven by a higher growth rate in filng fee payments.
- The final page of the financial statements display the Vending Service Fee paid to Civitek for operating the E-Filing Portal.
- As of April 30, Civitek was holding $4.75 M in reserves for future operations.

There were no questions.

The Honorable Todd Newton accepted the report as presented.

VIII. Progress Reports

E-Portal Progress Report

Mr. Michael Beckley, Portal Program Manager, reviewed the Portal Projects status report with the Board, noting the following topics:

- Single Session Rewrite Project
- Standard Document Descriptions Project
- 2026.02 November Release
- Status Page

He reviewed the highlights of the May 2026 Progress Report and Portal Release 2026.02.

Service Desk Report

Ms. Gia Howell reviewed the highlights of the May 2026 Service Desk Report.

IX. Florida Courts Technology Commission

Letter from Chief Justice Carlos Muñiz

The Honorable Todd Newton reviewed the letter from Chief Justice Muñiz asking the Authority to post a message to filers reflecting the new Supreme Court Order, SC2026-0673, noticing filers that the improper use of Ai and provides the court sanctions that could result in the court dismissing the filing, or even the case.

The Honorable Karen E. Rushing made a motion to authorize Chair Green to respond to Chief Justice Muñiz that the Authority would move forward with placing a message to filers. The Honorable Laura E. Roth, Esq., seconded the motion and all voted in favor.

The Honorable Karen E. Rushing also made a motion to authorize the Portal team to work with Lynn Hoshihara, Esq., on a notice reflecting the rule that would be placed in the Portal where it would easily be seen by filers. The Honorable Laura E. Roth, Esq., seconded the motion and all voted in favor.

As Chair Green was unable to attend, The Honorable Todd Newton read her FCTC report to the Board detailing several issues being discussed – the Portal Team providing an estimate for filer document linking and pro se filers. (see Attachment 2)

The Honorable Karen E. Rushing reminded everyone about the document description project, encouraging everyone to keep working on it as she was anticipating a push form FCTC on this standaraization effort. She spoke to the importance of getting the larger counties working on the project soon.

FCTC/RGPJAC Joint Work Group

Mr. Tom Hall informed the Board of the various issues beng reviewed by the joint work group. He informed the Baord about an RGPJAC subcommittee working on a potential new rule to require orders to have consistent titles. The Honorable Karen E. Rushing reminded him the RGP subcommittee needed to be made aware of the document description project and understand the potential for overlap. He agreed to do so. He also told the Board the joint work group was reviewing Rule 2.345, judges' electronic signatures, and the need to define what is an "electronic" signature. He noted a survey was going to be disseminated to determine how many orders were signed in paper.

Chair Newton reminded the Board the next FCTC meeting would be held August 13-14, 2026, in Orlando.

X. Old Business

There was no old business to discuss.

XI. New Business

Third Party Vendor Fees

The Honorable Todd Newton told the Board he has been made aware of more and more third party vendors applying to use the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal TPV process. As it had been 10 years since the TPV process has begun, he felt it was time to review the processes. He appointed The Honorable John

Tomasino to lead a work group to review the processes and fees and make recommendations to the Board.

Trademark Registration

Being aware that FCCC was reviewing all trademarks and brands, The Honorable Todd Newton asked Melissa Bennefield, FCCC COO, if she would include review the trademarks the Authority may wish to have, such as the Authority and Portal brand names and logos, with that effort and bring back a proposal.

XII. General Counsel Report

Ms. Hoshihara said there was nothing to bring to the Board's attention at this time.

XIII. Rules Report

Mr. Tom Hall informed the Board the Rules of General Practice and Judicial Administration Committee was still working possible changes to the "E-Everything" rule and the correction queue reasons, such as a filing with the wrong county name, splitting the final reason that seems to be two reasons into two, and rejecting a filing of a person who has been barred from filng in the court.

He noted there is continued discussion of having a standard notice of related cases. He also explained the issue of the appellate service list was still in play and there is the possibility of the rulebeing changed to mandate attorneys to only use the three email addresses they have in the Portal.

XIV. Public Comment

There were no questions.

XV. Adjourn

The Hnorable Todd Newton thanked everyone on the Board and in the audience for their time and attendance. The meeting was adjourned at 9:17 am, ET.

ATTACHMENT 1

2025-2026 Annual Report

I first want to tell you, I am honored to be a member of the E-Filing Authority.

I have been on the Board for a long time, but seeing from this perspective what your teams can do and watching the continued growth of the E-Filing Portal gives me a sense of awe.

I cannot tell you how proud I am to be part of this.

While the number of users continue to grow, we did something really unique this year.

But let me start with a few facts for perspective:

Like we see every year, the usage of the Florida Courts E-Filng Portal continues to grow. At the end of May 2025, there were 744,200 user accounts. That same time this year, we now have 985,199 user accounts.

We are track for having one million accounts by the end of the year, if not before.

And, with that number of users, the Portal is processing almost 2 million filings a month to Florida Courts.

Looking back to the beginning, we thought the through-put would only be about 5 million a year.

Isn't that something….in just a few short years we were far past that number!

But here's what we did a few months ago…..

This past year, the Authority entered into a Supplemental Agreement with the Florida Court Clerks and Comptrollers for the implementaion of expanded services—services that would provide added value to the users.

The agreement was broad, allowing the Authority to consider concepts that would be presented to them.

As such, the association suggested providing Portal users access to certain publicly available case types in the association's Comprehensive Case Information System through a subscription service.

Because FCCC is contracted to provide Authority services and operate the Portal, it only made sense.

Since the the value added service agreement foir CCIS signed in the fall, I know the Portal team and the CCIS team have been working tirelessly to make this happen – and we should be seeing results in a short few months!

The concept of the Authority being able to provide value-added services to its users is groundbreaking and I look forward to hearing more about it in the coming months.

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But this is why I emphasize-- Florida's E-Filing Authority relies on <u>all of you</u> to make Florida's e-filing efforts successful.

Our success is due all of your hard work, the hard work in your offices, and the belief that we can accomplish what we set out to do. I hope you, too, are proud to be part of the Florida's E-Filing acheivements.

Thank you, truly, for all you do.

ATTACHMENT 2

Florida Courts Technology Commission (FCTC) Update

During the most recent Florida Courts Technology Commission (FCTC) meeting, two primary requests were directed at the Portal Program for further analysis and consideration.

Document Linking Estimate Request

The Commission requested that the Portal Team develop an estimate associated with potential document-linking functionality within the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal. This request aligns with recommendations previously provided by the Florida Courts Technology Commission (FCTC) to the E-Filing Authority in its August 10, 2023, correspondence regarding Portal modifications to support enhanced judicial case management. Among the recommendations was the ability for filers to link related documents and for those relationships to be transmitted to the Clerk case maintenance systems and Court Application Processing Systems to improve case management automation and reporting.

The Portal Team is currently working to develop the estimate in advance of the August 13–14, 2026 FCTC meeting, where the Commission is expected to continue its discussion of this initiative.

Pro Se Filing Analysis and Reporting

The second area of focus centered on requests for information and reporting related to Pro Se filers. The discussion appeared to stem from concerns that increased use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools by self-represented litigants may be contributing to a rise in filing volumes and the number of documents being submitted through the Portal.

The Commission requested additional reporting and analysis regarding Pro Se filing activity, including filing volumes, filing trends, case and document characteristics, and the impact on overall Portal activity. The Commission also requested county-specific reporting for Sarasota, Broward, and Miami-Dade Counties to better understand trends associated with Pro Se filers and unrepresented defendants.

The Portal Program team is currently developing and refining the requested reports and analyses. As part of this effort, the team is evaluating available data sources, identifying any limitations associated with the requested metrics, and

determining the most effective approach for providing meaningful information to the Commission regarding Pro Se filing activity and related filing trends.